



Jaipur Watch Company has carved a niche with its coin watches. Prices range from ₹18,000 to ₹2.55 lakh

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JWC has raised approximately ₹3.5 crore in funding and is preparing for a fresh investment round to expand production.

In its early years, JWC had to import most components—cases, dials, straps, movements. Over time, the domestic supply chain has evolved, with Indian vendors now supplying high-quality stainless-steel cases, sapphire glass, leather straps, and bracelets. Movements, however, remain imported, primarily from Japan.

The company has carved a niche with its coin watches, incorporat-

ing historical Indian currency. One recent launch, The One, features a rare 1938–1940 Quarter Anna coin, a green dial with Devanagari numerals, and the country’s first adjustable mesh bracelet.

The design is heritage-inspired but contemporary in execution, an approach that defines the brand’s broader aesthetic. It retails for ₹50,000.

“Our collections are like limited editions,” says Mehta. “We rarely remake designs once they’re sold out.” Among its bestsellers is the Bagh collection. The company’s pricing ranges from ₹18,000 to

₹2.55 lakh for diamond-studded or bespoke pieces.

In the south, another horological venture is quietly building a cult following. The Bangalore Watch Company (BWC), founded in 2018 by husband-and-wife team of Nirupesh Joshi and Mercy Amalraj, represents a different approach. Based in the same city that birthed HMT—Independent India’s first horological start-up founded in 1963—BWC draws inspiration from contemporary India: space missions, cricket, aviation, and the outdoors. “We wanted to change the grammar of Indian watch design,” says Joshi. “We pick themes that we are confident will create a cultural resonance with our audience for decades.”

With an annual production of around 1,500 pieces priced between ₹1 lakh and ₹2.5 lakh, BWC has kept its scale small, but ambitions focused. The brand exclusively sells online and through a private studio in Bengaluru. It imports the movements from Switzerland.

BWC’s Apogee range, launched last year, became the first Made-in-India timepiece qualified for space flight, with prices ranging from ₹92,000 to ₹2.4 lakh. Another collection incorporated recycled metal from aircraft carrier *INS Vikrant* into its casebacks. This year, the brand will showcase two watches from its Peninsula collection at the GPHG—marking its debut at the event.

Nearly 35% of BWC’s sales come from international buyers, and while the company remains self-funded, Joshi says they are now preparing for a formal fundraising round.

As these independent watchmakers gain traction — from Jaipur to Bengaluru—a new chapter is being written in Indian horology that blends heritage with innovation. **BT**

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